

# حُرُوفُ الْقُرْآنِ

## The 86 Particles of the Qur'an

Every particle, its sound, its meaning, how it works, and how often it occurs

Mohammed Sajid Khan  
[ibnqutb.com](http://ibnqutb.com)

# How to use this table

Arabic words are of three kinds: nouns, verbs and particles. Nouns and verbs number in the thousands and must be learned root by root. The particles are different. There are only 86 of them in the whole Qur'an, and between them they occur 47,877 times, counting the ones attached to other words, such as the **ﻝ** and the **ﻪ** at the front of a word. Hardly an ayah is without several of them. A student who knows these 86 words has learned the joints that hold every sentence of the Qur'an together.

The particles are grouped by what they do, following the classical grammarians' categories: the prepositions that pull a noun into the genitive, the conjunctions that join, the particles that change a verb's mood, the negatives, the conditionals, and so on. Within each group they are listed by how often they occur, so the first rows of each group are the ones to learn first.

Each row gives the particle as it is written with its vowel marks, its sound in English letters, the nearest English meanings, a short note on how it works in a sentence, and its count in the Qur'an. Some particles appear in more than one category with different senses; they are listed under the category of their most common use.

These tables are taken from my app **Quran Words/Root: Voice Search**, where each particle links to every ayah it occurs in, and from the lessons at [ibnqutb.com](http://ibnqutb.com), where the free Beginners Grammar course explains each category in full.

## حُرُوفُ الْجَرِّ Particles of Attraction (prepositions)

11

| PARTICLE | SOUND        | MEANING                                     | HOW IT WORKS                                                                                                                                                                                                | IN THE QUR'AN |
|----------|--------------|---------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------|
| مِنْ     | <i>min</i>   | <b>from, of, some of, than</b>              | Puts the noun after it in the genitive. Marks where something starts, what a thing is part of, or what it is made of; after a comparative it is “than”.                                                     | 3,226         |
| بِ       | <i>bi</i>    | <b>with, by, in, at, for</b>                | Attached to the front of a noun and puts it in the genitive. The widest of the prepositions: the tool used, the price paid, the place stayed, the oath sworn, and it makes an intransitive verb transitive. | 2,544         |
| لِ       | <i>li</i>    | <b>for, to, belonging to</b>                | Attached to the front of a noun and puts it in the genitive. Ownership, the one something is done for, or the reason it is done.                                                                            | 2,451         |
| فِي      | <i>fee</i>   | <b>in, inside, during, concerning</b>       | Puts the noun after it in the genitive. Being inside a place, a time or a subject.                                                                                                                          | 1,701         |
| عَلَى    | <i>'ala</i>  | <b>on, upon, over, against</b>              | Puts the noun after it in the genitive. Rest or weight on top of something; also duty laid on someone, and harm done against them.                                                                          | 1,444         |
| إِلَى    | <i>ila</i>   | <b>to, towards, up to</b>                   | Puts the noun after it in the genitive. The end point of a movement or a stretch of time; the pair of مِنْ.                                                                                                 | 742           |
| عَنْ     | <i>'an</i>   | <b>from, away from, about, on behalf of</b> | Puts the noun after it in the genitive. Moving away from something, or speaking about it.                                                                                                                   | 465           |
| كَ       | <i>ka</i>    | <b>like, as</b>                             | Attached to the front of a noun and puts it in the genitive. Likeness and comparison.                                                                                                                       | 287           |
| حَتَّى   | <i>hatta</i> | <b>until, up to, as far as</b>              | Puts the noun after it in the genitive. The last point of a stretch, and that point is included.                                                                                                            | 95            |
| وَ       | <i>wa</i>    | <b>by — (in an oath)</b>                    | The وَ of the oath: وَالْفَجْرِ, “by the dawn”. Puts the noun sworn by in the genitive.                                                                                                                     | 28            |
| تَ       | <i>ta</i>    | <b>by — (in an oath)</b>                    | The تَ of the oath, used in the Qur'an only with the name of Allah: تَاللَّهِ. Rarer and stronger than the وَ of the oath.                                                                                  | 9             |

## حُرُوفُ الْعَطْفِ Particles of Joining (conjunctions)

7

| PARTICLE | SOUND     | MEANING    | HOW IT WORKS                                                                                  | IN THE QUR'AN |
|----------|-----------|------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------|
| وَ       | <i>wa</i> | <b>and</b> | Joins two words or clauses without saying which came first. The commonest word in the Qur'an. | 8,177         |

| PARTICLE | SOUND         | MEANING                                    | HOW IT WORKS                                                                                                                                      | IN THE QUR'AN |
|----------|---------------|--------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------|
| فَ       | <i>fa</i>     | <b>so, and — (starting a new sentence)</b> | The ف of resumption: it opens a new sentence that follows on in sense from the last, without being joined to it grammatically.                    | 1,891         |
| وَ       | <i>wa</i>     | <b>and — (starting a new sentence)</b>     | The و of resumption: it opens a fresh sentence rather than joining onto the last one, so what follows does not take the case of what came before. | 1,034         |
| فَ       | <i>fa</i>     | <b>so, then, and so</b>                    | Joins, and adds order and closeness: what follows came straight after, or straight out of, what came before.                                      | 517           |
| ثُمَّ    | <i>thumma</i> | <b>then, thereafter</b>                    | Joins with order and a gap: what follows came later, after a delay.                                                                               | 338           |
| أَوْ     | <i>aw</i>     | <b>or</b>                                  | Offers one of two, whether as a choice, a permission or a doubt.                                                                                  | 280           |
| أَمْ     | <i>am</i>     | <b>or — (in a question)</b>                | The “or” that belongs to a question, answering a هَلْ or a questioning هَمْزَةً: “is it this, or that?”                                           | 137           |

## حُرُوفُ النَّصْبِ Particles that put the verb in the Accusative

5

| PARTICLE | SOUND      | MEANING                             | HOW IT WORKS                                                                                                                         | IN THE QUR'AN |
|----------|------------|-------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------|
| لِ       | <i>li</i>  | <b>so that, in order to</b>         | لَامُ التَّعْلِيلِ: puts the present verb in the accusative and gives the reason the action was done.                                | 319           |
| لَنْ     | <i>lan</i> | <b>will never, shall not</b>        | Puts the present verb in the accusative and denies it for the future, flatly.                                                        | 106           |
| فَ       | <i>fa</i>  | <b>and so, with the result that</b> | فَاءُ السَّبَبِيَّةِ: after a command or a denial it puts the present verb in the accusative and names what would follow from it.    | 88            |
| كَيْ     | <i>kay</i> | <b>so that, in order that</b>       | Puts the present verb in the accusative and gives the purpose of the action before it.                                               | 7             |
| وَ       | <i>wa</i>  | <b>together with</b>                | The و of accompaniment (وَإِوَاءُ الْمُعِيَّةِ): the noun after it is in the accusative and means the action happened along with it. | 3             |

## حُرُوفُ الْجَزْمِ Particles that put the verb in the Jussive

4

| PARTICLE | SOUND      | MEANING                 | HOW IT WORKS                                                                                                | IN THE QUR'AN |
|----------|------------|-------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------|
| لَمْ     | <i>lam</i> | <b>did not, has not</b> | Puts the present verb in the jussive and throws its meaning into the past: لَمْ يَلِدْ: “he did not beget”. | 348           |
| لَا      | <i>la</i>  | <b>do not —</b>         | The forbidding لَا: puts the present verb in the jussive and turns it into a prohibition.                   | 332           |

| PARTICLE | SOUND        | MEANING        | HOW IT WORKS                                                                                                                                 | IN THE QUR'AN |
|----------|--------------|----------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------|
| لِ       | <i>li</i>    | <b>let —</b>   | لَاَمُ الْأَمْرِ: puts the present verb in the jussive and turns it into a command, usually to a third person: فَلْيَنْظُرْ, “let him look”. | 78            |
| لَمَّا   | <i>lamma</i> | <b>not yet</b> | Puts the present verb in the jussive and denies it up to now, leaving it still expected.                                                     | 8             |

## الحُرُوفُ الْمُشَبَّهَةُ بِالْفِعْلِ Particles that act like a verb

7

| PARTICLE | SOUND          | MEANING                                 | HOW IT WORKS                                                                                                             | IN THE QUR'AN |
|----------|----------------|-----------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------|
| إِنَّ    | <i>inna</i>    | <b>indeed, truly</b>                    | Puts its subject in the accusative and its predicate in the nominative. The strongest way to state something as certain. | 1,682         |
| أَنَّ    | <i>anna</i>    | <b>that</b>                             | The same word as إِنَّ but inside a sentence, after a verb of knowing or saying: “he knew that ...”.                     | 362           |
| لَعَلَّ  | <i>la'alla</i> | <b>so that, perhaps, it may be that</b> | Hope or expectation. In the Qur'an it usually points to the purpose behind a command: لَعَلَّكُمْ تَتَّقُونَ.            | 129           |
| لَكِنَّ  | <i>lakinna</i> | <b>but, however</b>                     | Corrects or qualifies what was just said, and puts its subject in the accusative.                                        | 65            |
| كَأَنَّ  | <i>ka-anna</i> | <b>as though, as if</b>                 | Likeness stated as a fact: “as though they were ...”.                                                                    | 31            |
| لَيْتَ   | <i>layta</i>   | <b>if only, would that</b>              | A wish for something that is not so, and usually cannot be.                                                              | 14            |
| كَأَنَّ  | <i>ka-anna</i> | <b>as though, as if</b>                 | Likeness stated as a fact: “as though they were ...”.                                                                    | 9             |

## حُرُوفُ النِّفْيِ Particles of Negation

4

| PARTICLE | SOUND      | MEANING        | HOW IT WORKS                                                                                                                                               | IN THE QUR'AN |
|----------|------------|----------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------|
| لَا      | <i>la</i>  | <b>not, no</b> | Denies. With the present verb it denies now or later; with an indefinite noun in the accusative it denies the whole class — لَا رَيْبَ, “no doubt at all”. | 1,410         |
| مَا      | <i>ma</i>  | <b>not</b>     | Denies a past act, or a present state, as a plain statement of fact.                                                                                       | 705           |
| إِنْ     | <i>in</i>  | <b>not</b>     | إِنْ used as a denial rather than a condition, often followed by إِلَّا: “this is nothing but ...”.                                                        | 116           |
| كَيْ     | <i>kay</i> | <b>not</b>     | كَيْ carrying a denial rather than a purpose.                                                                                                              | 3             |

## حُرُوفُ الشَّرْطِ Particles of Condition

4

| PARTICLE | SOUND        | MEANING                            | HOW IT WORKS                                                                                                            | IN THE QUR'AN |
|----------|--------------|------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------|
| إِنْ     | <i>in</i>    | <b>if</b>                          | The plain conditional: puts both the condition verb and its answer in the jussive. Used for what may or may not happen. | 578           |
| لَوْ     | <i>law</i>   | <b>if — (but it was not so)</b>    | A condition known not to have happened, so its answer did not happen either: “had it been ..., then ...”.               | 189           |
| لَوْلَا  | <i>lawla</i> | <b>were it not for, if not for</b> | Denies the answer because of something that is present: “were it not for the grace of your Lord ...”.                   | 34            |
| إِمَّا   | <i>imma</i>  | <b>if ever, whether</b>            | إِنْ with مَا added: a condition put with more force.                                                                   | 9             |

## حُرُوفُ الاسْتِفْهَامِ Particles of Question

3

| PARTICLE | SOUND      | MEANING                                 | HOW IT WORKS                                                                                                                                                                                             | IN THE QUR'AN |
|----------|------------|-----------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------|
| أَ       | <i>a</i>   | <b>is ...? did ...? do ...?</b>         | The questioning hamza, fixed to the front of the word. It can ask a plain question, or ask in wonder or in reproach.                                                                                     | 507           |
| هَلْ     | <i>hal</i> | <b>is it that ...? do ...?</b>          | Asks a question whose answer is yes or no.                                                                                                                                                               | 93            |
| أَ       | <i>a</i>   | <b>whether — (“whether ... or ...”)</b> | هَمْزَةُ التَّسْوِيَةِ: it is not really asking. Paired with أَمْ it says the two make no difference: أَلَمْ تُنذِرْهُمْ أَمْ لَمْ تُنذِرْهُمْ سَوَاءٌ عَلَيْهِمْ أَلَّذَرْتَهُمْ أَمْ لَمْ تُنذِرْهُمْ. | 6             |

## حُرُوفُ التَّوَكِيدِ Particles of Emphasis

4

| PARTICLE | SOUND        | MEANING                                         | HOW IT WORKS                                                                                                                          | IN THE QUR'AN |
|----------|--------------|-------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------|
| لَ       | <i>la</i>    | <b>surely, indeed</b>                           | لَاَمُ الْإِبْتِدَاءِ / لَاَمُ التَّوَكِيدِ: attached to the front of a word to swear to it or drive it home, often paired with إِنْ. | 1,001         |
| قَدْ     | <i>qad</i>   | <b>indeed, already; sometimes</b>               | With a past verb it confirms the act has certainly happened; with a present verb it means it happens sometimes.                       | 406           |
| سَ       | <i>-anna</i> | <b>surely — (attached to the end of a verb)</b> | نُونُ التَّوَكِيدِ: fixed to the end of a verb, heavy (عَنّ) or light (عَنْ), to swear the action will happen.                        | 243           |
| إِنَّ    | <i>in</i>    | <b>indeed</b>                                   | إِنَّ الْمُخَفَّفَةُ, إِنَّ: lightened: it still confirms, and is usually followed by a لَ.                                           | 9             |

## حُرُوفُ الْجَوَابِ Particles of Answer

5

| PARTICLE | SOUND        | MEANING                                      | HOW IT WORKS                                                                                                           | IN THE QUR'AN |
|----------|--------------|----------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------|
| كَلَّا   | <i>kalla</i> | <b>no indeed!<br/>certainly not!</b>         | حَرْفُ الرَّدِّع: it stops the hearer short and scolds them for what they said or thought.                             | 33            |
| إِذَا    | <i>idhan</i> | <b>in that case, then</b>                    | Answers what has just been said and draws the consequence from it.                                                     | 31            |
| بَلَى    | <i>bala</i>  | <b>yes indeed —<br/>(answering a denial)</b> | The only word that says “yes” to a negative question, and it reverses the denial: أَلَسْتُ بِرَبِّكُمْ؟ قَالُوا بَلَى. | 22            |
| نَعَمْ   | <i>na'am</i> | <b>yes</b>                                   | Agrees with what was said, whether it was put positively or negatively.                                                | 4             |
| إِي      | <i>ee</i>    | <b>yes, by —</b>                             | A yes strengthened by an oath; in the Qur'an only إِي وَرَبِّي.                                                        | 1             |

## حُرُوفُ الدَّاءِ Particles of Calling

2

| PARTICLE | SOUND        | MEANING                         | HOW IT WORKS                                                                                                            | IN THE QUR'AN |
|----------|--------------|---------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------|
| يَا      | <i>ya</i>    | <b>O —</b>                      | Calls to someone, whether far or near, and puts the one called in the accusative if the name is joined to another word. | 361           |
| وَم      | <i>-umma</i> | <b>O — (only in اللَّهُمَّ)</b> | The م ending اللَّهُمَّ stands in for the يَا of calling, which is why no يَا comes before it.                          | 5             |

## حُرُوفُ التَّنْبِيهِ Particles of Alerting

2

| PARTICLE | SOUND      | MEANING                         | HOW IT WORKS                                                                                                             | IN THE QUR'AN |
|----------|------------|---------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------|
| هَآ      | <i>ha</i>  | <b>look —, here —</b>           | حَرْفُ التَّنْبِيهِ: it wakes the hearer up before what follows, and it is the هَآ at the front of هَآذَا and هَؤُلَاءِ. | 484           |
| أَلَا    | <i>ala</i> | <b>behold! now<br/>surely —</b> | Opens a sentence and calls for full attention to it.                                                                     | 39            |

## حَرَفَا الْإِسْتِقْبَالِ Particles of the Future

2

| PARTICLE | SOUND     | MEANING                         | HOW IT WORKS                                                                                    | IN THE QUR'AN |
|----------|-----------|---------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------|
| سَ       | <i>sa</i> | <b>will, shall —<br/>(soon)</b> | Attached to the front of a present verb and throws it into the future, usually the near future. | 119           |

| PARTICLE | SOUND        | MEANING                        | HOW IT WORKS                                                          | IN THE QUR'AN |
|----------|--------------|--------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------|
| سَوْفَ   | <i>sawfa</i> | <b>will, shall — (in time)</b> | The same job as سَنَ but standing alone, and it points further ahead. | 42            |

## حُرُوفُ الْإِسْتِثْنَاءِ Particles of Exception

3

| PARTICLE | SOUND        | MEANING                  | HOW IT WORKS                                                                                                       | IN THE QUR'AN |
|----------|--------------|--------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------|
| إِلَّا   | <i>illa</i>  | <b>except, but, only</b> | After a denial it limits: مَا ... إِلَّا means “nothing but ...”. This is the ordinary way the Qur'an says “only”. | 557           |
| إِلَّا   | <i>illa</i>  | <b>except, save</b>      | Takes one thing out of a group already named, and puts it in the accusative.                                       | 102           |
| لَمَّا   | <i>lamma</i> | <b>except, but</b>       | لَمَّا standing in for إِلَّا after a denial.                                                                      | 3             |

## حُرُوفُ الْمَصْدَرِيَّةِ Particles that turn a verb into a noun

3

| PARTICLE | SOUND      | MEANING                    | HOW IT WORKS                                                                                                                    | IN THE QUR'AN |
|----------|------------|----------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------|
| أَنَّ    | <i>an</i>  | <b>to, that</b>            | Puts the present verb in the accusative and turns the whole clause into a noun: أَنْ تَصُومُوا, “that you fast / your fasting”. | 569           |
| مَا      | <i>ma</i>  | <b>that, the fact that</b> | مَا الْمَصْدَرِيَّةُ: turns the clause after it into a verbal noun.                                                             | 83            |
| لَوْ     | <i>law</i> | <b>that, if</b>            | لَوْ used to make a noun clause, after verbs of wishing: يَوَدُّ أَحَدُهُمْ لَوْ يُعَمَّرَ.                                     | 12            |

## حُرُوفُ التَّفْصِيلِ Particles of Detailing

2

| PARTICLE | SOUND       | MEANING              | HOW IT WORKS                                                                                            | IN THE QUR'AN |
|----------|-------------|----------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------|
| أَمَّا   | <i>amma</i> | <b>as for —</b>      | Takes up one part of what was mentioned and deals with it on its own; its answer always begins with فَ. | 55            |
| إِمَّا   | <i>imma</i> | <b>either — or —</b> | Sets two possibilities side by side, and is repeated for the second.                                    | 14            |

## حُرُوفُ الْإِضْرَابِ وَالِاسْتِدْرَاكِ Particles of Retraction and Correction

4

| PARTICLE | SOUND        | MEANING                                  | HOW IT WORKS                                                                      | IN THE QUR'AN |
|----------|--------------|------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------|
| بَلْ     | <i>bal</i>   | <b>rather, no — but</b>                  | Turns away from what was just said and states something else instead.             | 122           |
| لَكِنْ   | <i>lakin</i> | <b>but, yet</b>                          | لَكِنْ lightened: it corrects what was said without governing the words after it. | 65            |
| بَلْ     | <i>bal</i>   | <b>rather — (opening a new sentence)</b> | بَلْ starting a fresh statement instead of joining onto the last.                 | 4             |
| بَلْ     | <i>bal</i>   | <b>rather, no — but</b>                  | Cancels what was just said and puts something else in its place.                  | 1             |

## حُرُوفُ التَّحْضِيضِ Particles of Urging

1

| PARTICLE | SOUND        | MEANING            | HOW IT WORKS                                              | IN THE QUR'AN |
|----------|--------------|--------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------|---------------|
| لَوْلَا  | <i>lawla</i> | <b>why not — ?</b> | Urging, and blaming for not doing: “why did you not ...?” | 41            |

## الحُرُوفُ الزَّائِدَةُ Extra particles (added for weight, not sense)

4

| PARTICLE | SOUND     | MEANING                                           | HOW IT WORKS                                                                                                                             | IN THE QUR'AN |
|----------|-----------|---------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------|
| مَا      | <i>ma</i> | <b>— (blocks the word before it from working)</b> | مَا الْكَافَّةُ: attached to إِنَّ, كَأَنَّ or a preposition it stops them governing the words after, so the sentence carries on freely. | 162           |
| فَ       | <i>fa</i> | <b>— (added, no sense of its own)</b>             | A فَ put in for the run of the sentence, carrying no new meaning.                                                                        | 155           |
| وَ       | <i>wa</i> | <b>— (added, no sense of its own)</b>             | A وَ put in for the run of the sentence, carrying no new meaning.                                                                        | 59            |
| مَا      | <i>ma</i> | <b>— (added, no sense of its own)</b>             | مَا الزَّائِدَةُ: it adds nothing to the sense but strengthens the word it follows.                                                      | 23            |

## حَرْفُ التَّعْرِيفِ The Particle of Definiteness

1

| PARTICLE | SOUND      | MEANING    | HOW IT WORKS                                                                                                               | IN THE QUR'AN |
|----------|------------|------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------|
| الْ      | <i>al-</i> | <b>the</b> | Fixed to the front of a noun to make it definite. It can point to a thing already known, or to the whole class of a thing. | 8,377         |

## حُرُوفُ أُخْرَى Other particles

7

| PARTICLE | SOUND | MEANING                          | HOW IT WORKS                                                                                                                   | IN THE QUR'AN |
|----------|-------|----------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------|
| كَ       | -ka   | — (marks who is being spoken to) | كَافُ الْخُطَابِ, the ك ending ذَٰلِكَ: it agrees with the person addressed, not with the thing pointed at.                    | 738           |
| لِ       | -li   | — (marks that thing as far off)  | لَامُ الْبُعْدِ, the ل inside ذَٰلِكَ and أُولَٰئِكَ: it says the thing pointed at is distant, not near.                       | 531           |
| فَ       | fa    | then, so                         | فَاءُ الْجَوَابِ: it opens the answer to a condition, an oath or a command.                                                    | 350           |
| وَ       | wa    | while, with                      | The وَ of state (وَإِذَا الْحَالُ): it opens a clause describing the state someone was in while the main action happened.      | 293           |
| أَنَّ    | an    | namely, that is                  | أَنَّ الْمَقْسَرَةَ: it introduces the very words or the content of a message just mentioned.                                  | 47            |
| حَتَّى   | hatta | until — (then a whole sentence)  | حَتَّى الْإِثْبَاتِيَّةُ: what follows it is a full sentence, not a noun in the genitive nor a verb in the accusative.         | 47            |
| إِذَا    | idha  | and there — suddenly             | إِذَا الْفَجَائِيَّةُ, the إِذَا of surprise: it comes after فَ and opens on something happening all at once, with no warning. | 40            |

## حُرُوفُ الْمَقْطَعَةِ The Disconnected Letters

1

| PARTICLE | SOUND | MEANING                            | HOW IT WORKS                                                                                                                                            | IN THE QUR'AN |
|----------|-------|------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------|
|          |       | — (their meaning is not disclosed) | الْحُرُوفُ الْمَقْطَعَةُ, the letters that open twenty-nine surahs, read one by one rather than as a word. The Qur'an does not say what they stand for. | 30            |